Ballot Measure No. 2 - 24ESEG

An Act Restoring Political Party Primaries, Ending Ranked-Choice General Elections, and Repealing Recent Campaign Finance Laws

STATEMENT IN SUPPORT

Voting Yes on Ballot Measure 2 restores Alaska's elections to how they were before 2020:

1. End Ranked Choice Voting
2. Bring Back Open Primaries
3. Restore Pre-2020 Campaign Disclosure Laws

(1) Yes on 2 Ends Ranked Choice Voting

- Dark Money: Out-of-state dark money groups have spent tens of millions of dollars trying to sell Alaskans on ranked choice voting.
- Banned in 19 States: Dark money billionaires from the lower 48 are losing the fight for ranked choice voting all over the country. They hope that, if they spend enough dark money here, Alaskans will keep their failed system.
- Complicated Ballots: Ranked choice ballots are a complicated mess. Ending ranked choice voting will return to simple, One Person, One Vote elections.
- Trashed Ballots: Thousands of ballots don't count every year. Ending ranked choice voting will ensure that election results represent the will of all voters, not just the ones who properly fill out an overly-complex ballot.
- Manipulated Results: Due to low turnout, trashed ballots, and incorrectly filled out ballots, the results of every election are not representative of Alaskans. This harms Alaskans, but helps candidates supported by the out-of-state dark money.
- High Risk: Ranked choice voting has created many documented cases of election irregularities. Worse, it is impossible to verify those questionable results by human hand count - instead we have to just trust a computer algorithm.
- Waiting Weeks for Results: Results already take forever to collect from across Alaska. Ranked choice voting makes that problem even worse by delaying results for weeks.

(2) Yes on 2 Brings Back Open Primaries

- Bring Back Open Primaries: Yes on 2 will *not* close Alaska's primaries. That's a lie. Our primaries will return to the pre-2020 system that was open to 100% of Alaskans - including those who are not members of any party.
- Alaska's History of Open Primaries: A nonpartisan study by the Bipartisan Policy Center rated Alaska's elections before the 2020 Jungle Primary system as "Open." That's because they were Open to 100% of Alaskan voters. A Yes vote on 2 restores that same Open Primary system.
- Dark Money Lies: The same out-of-state money falsely claiming that Yes on 2 will close Alaska's primaries actually funded the nonpartisan study that rated our elections as "Open." So, they know better. They must just think Alaskans are dumb.
- End the Jungle Primary: Yes on 2 will end the complicated jungle primary system that resulted in 17 candidates for governor this year and 48 candidates for Congress in 2022.

(3) Yes on 2 Restores Pre-2020 Campaign Disclosure Laws

- Dark Money is Still Flowing: The same out-of-state billionaires claiming that a Yes on 2 will cause dark money to flow into Alaska have spent tens of millions of dollars in dark money to protect ranked choice voting.
- Defeat Ranked Choice Dark Money: Yes on 2 will defeat the largest source of dark money Alaska has ever seen - the tens of millions of dollars spent to support ranked choice voting.

Mead Treadwell, former Lt. Governor of Alaska
Craig Campbell, former Lt. Governor of Alaska
Loren Leman, former Lt. Governor of Alaska

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STATEMENT IN OPPOSITION

Measure 2 would flood Alaska with untraceable campaign cash, take away our freedom to vote for any candidate we choose, and allow politicians to win without a majority of the vote.

To stop Dark Money and to stop political insiders from taking away your right to vote for who you want, VOTE NO.

Alaska's election system has three parts that together make us unique from any other state in the country:

- Dark Money disclosure laws give us the right to know who is spending in our elections and require outside spenders to publicly disclose the true source of their funding.
- Open primaries ensure political parties do not control our primary elections and that every Alaskan has the right to vote for whichever candidates we want.
- Ranked choice voting ensures that the winning candidate must earn the support of a majority of the voters.

Ballot Measure 2 would get rid of all three parts.

Why are the sponsors of this initiative ONLY talking about repealing ranked choice voting, with no mention of the flood of anonymous campaign cash coming our way if it passes?

Because they are trying to hide what this measure is really about:

- Ballot Measure 2 gets rid of campaign finance transparency requirements and allows secret, undisclosed spending in Alaska's elections.
- Ballot Measure 2 also gives political party bosses the right to deny unaffiliated voters the ability to vote in primary elections. 60%+ of Alaskan voters are unaffiliated.

Voting No protects voter freedom:

- Voting No says NO to Outside Billionaires buying our elections with no accountability.
- Voting No affirms that Alaskans have the right to know who is spending in our elections.
- Voting No protects every Alaskans' freedom to vote in every election.

A few questions to consider before you vote:

- Do you think we should have LESS transparency in our elections?
- Do you think names of those spending money in Alaska's elections should be kept SECRET?
- Do you think we should give more power and influence to political party insiders and their outside billionaire donors?
- Do you think we should allow political parties to ban 60%+ of Alaskans from voting in primary elections just because they prefer not to join a party?

If your answers to any of these questions is NO, you should vote NO on Ballot Measure 2.

This is the third time in six years that Alaskans are being asked to vote on our election system. Special interest groups and political party insiders are demanding we waste more time and money on this costly repeat ballot measure so that they can take power away from the voters and back for themselves.

This issue is not Democrats vs. Republicans. It is Alaskans vs. Outside Billionaires and political insiders.
Vote No on Measure 2 to stop Dark Money and protect Alaskans' independence.

Nicole Borromeo, President, ANCSA Regional Association
Sen. Cathy Giessel, Senate Majority Leader (R)
Joelle Hall, President, Alaska AFL-CIO

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